



PAPUA NEW GUINEA

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 20 JULY 2026 - 26 JULY 2026

POLESTAR-ADVISORY.COM

BOTTOM LINE UP FRONT

The most serious validated development in Papua New Guinea was kama sda student found dead; police investigate alleged murder on 22 July 2026. During the reporting period, maritime and violent crime events were the main concerns, recorded mainly in Madang, Papua New Guinea and Enga. Businesses should note that risk varies by location and plan movement around the affected areas.

TOP 3 DEVELOPMENTS

KAMA SDA STUDENT FOUND DEAD; POLICE INVESTIGATE ALLEGED MURDER:

HIGH

Homicide / violent crime · Reported 22 Jul 2026 · EMTV (PNG)

Heightened personal-security risk locally; review after-hours exposure and movement protocols.

One of two Baisu escapees shot dead

HIGH

Homicide / violent crime · Reported 21 Jul 2026 · NBC PNG

Heightened personal-security risk locally; review after-hours exposure and movement protocols.

Pacific Towings Tugboat rescues passengers off Madang

LOW

Other security · Madang · Reported 26 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier

Security-relevant development; monitor for operational follow-on in the affected area.

INCIDENT DETAILS

OTHER OPERATIONAL DISRUPTION

Operational disruption to transport, utilities or connectivity was reported, including other security, aviation and maritime, concentrated in Madang. The most serious reported was Wasaeya Elementary Classroom damaged in alleged arson incident, assessed as High severity. This activity was more prominent than in the previous week. This reporting is most relevant to transport, power, communications and the operations that depend on them. Disruption of this kind can interrupt operations, logistics and connectivity.

Wasaeya Elementary Classroom damaged in alleged arson incident

HIGH

Other security · Location not specified · Reported 26 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier (PNG)

Taipei protests as PNG orders Taiwan office shut - Islands Business

MODERATE

Other security · Location not specified · Reported 20 Jul 2026 · Google News — Papua New Guinea (Civil Unrest)

Reconnecting Rural and remote Papua New Guinea

LOW

Aviation / airport · Location not specified · Reported 26 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier (PNG)

Pacific Towings Tugboat rescues passengers off Madang

LOW

Other security · Madang · Reported 26 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier

Tomuriesa takes over Civil Aviation Ministry

LOW

Aviation / airport · Location not specified · Reported 25 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier (PNG)

Outgoing Civil Aviation Minister Wake Goi highlights significant progress in Aviation Sector

LOW

Aviation / airport · Location not specified · Reported 24 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier (PNG)

GOVERNOR MARUM EXPRESS APPRECIATION TO CAPTAIN RUH FOR HIS COMMITMENT IN TRANSPORTING 3 RECOVERED BODIES

LOW

Other security · Location not specified · Reported 23 Jul 2026 · PNG Haus Bung

PNG's East New Britain province devastated by unfolding maritime tragedy

LOW

Maritime / port · Location not specified · Reported 22 Jul 2026 · RNZ Pacific

PPC Baim urges people not to politicize police recruitment drive

LOW

Other security · Location not specified · Reported 22 Jul 2026 · NBC PNG

CRIME, THEFT & ROBBERY

Crime, theft and violent incidents were reported, including violent crime and communal violence, concentrated in Enga. The most serious reported was Community education and grief counselling key to end sorcery-related violence in PNG, Catholic priest says, assessed as High severity. This activity was less prominent than in the previous week. This reporting is most relevant to staff safety, premises, vehicles and the secure movement of cash and assets. Incidents of this kind threaten staff, premises and the movement of cash and assets.

Community education and grief counselling key to end sorcery-related violence in PNG, Catholic priest says

HIGH

Homicide / violent crime · Location not specified · Reported 22 Jul 2026 · RNZ Pacific

Police warn tribal fight organisers as Enga enforcement intensifies

HIGH

Tribal / communal violence · Enga · Reported 21 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier

Indonesia Seeks Answers From Papua New Guinea Over Fisherman's Shooting

LOW

Homicide / violent crime · Location not specified · Reported 26 Jul 2026 · Google News — West Papua (Insurgency & Violence)

Indonesia seeks PNG clarification on fishing boat shooting

LOW

Homicide / violent crime · Location not specified · Reported 26 Jul 2026 · Google News — West Papua (Insurgency & Violence)

GOVERNANCE & REGULATORY

Policing, regulatory and governance-related activity was reported, including policing operation, reported across several areas without a single focus. The most serious reported was Operation 'Rausim Illegal Gambling' nets 65 arrests in WHP and Jiwaka, assessed as Moderate severity. This activity was less prominent than in the previous week. This reporting is most relevant to permits, compliance, checkpoints and freedom of movement. Regulatory, policing and governance friction can affect compliance, permits and freedom of movement.

Operation 'Rausim Illegal Gambling' nets 65 arrests in WHP and Jiwaka

MODERATE

Policing operation · Location not specified · Reported 22 Jul 2026 · NBC PNG

Police arrest 65 illegal gamblers in Jiwaka and Western Highlands Province

MODERATE

Policing operation · Location not specified · Reported 20 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier (PNG)

CURRENT SITUATION

Security incidents in Papua New Guinea during the reporting period were concentrated in Madang, Papua New Guinea and Enga. Maritime and violent crime were the principal concerns. The incidents do not currently form a single nationwide pattern; risk varies by location, and movement decisions should be based on current conditions at the destination.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

MOVEMENT

- Confirm current route conditions before travel into affected districts.
- Avoid non-essential after-hours movement where recent violence has occurred.
- Allow extra travel time where police activity or local gatherings are reported.

SITE SECURITY

- Review access arrangements at sites close to reported incidents.
- Confirm after-hours escalation procedures with guards and site managers.
- Check that emergency contacts and reporting lines remain current.

STAFF AWARENESS

- Brief affected staff on specific locations and current restrictions.
- Reinforce immediate reporting of roadblocks, violence or police activity.
- Share only verified areas to avoid.

TRANSPORT AND LOGISTICS

- Confirm airport, port and road status before affected movements.

OUTLOOK: NEXT SEVEN DAYS

Maritime is likely to remain the main concern during the next seven days. Madang, Papua New Guinea and Enga should remain under review because incidents were reported there during the period.

ESCALATION INDICATORS

- Larger or coordinated protest mobilisation, or labour action spreading to key sites and corridors
- Further casualty-bearing or higher-severity violence close to staffed premises
- Spread of incidents beyond Madang and Enga into new districts

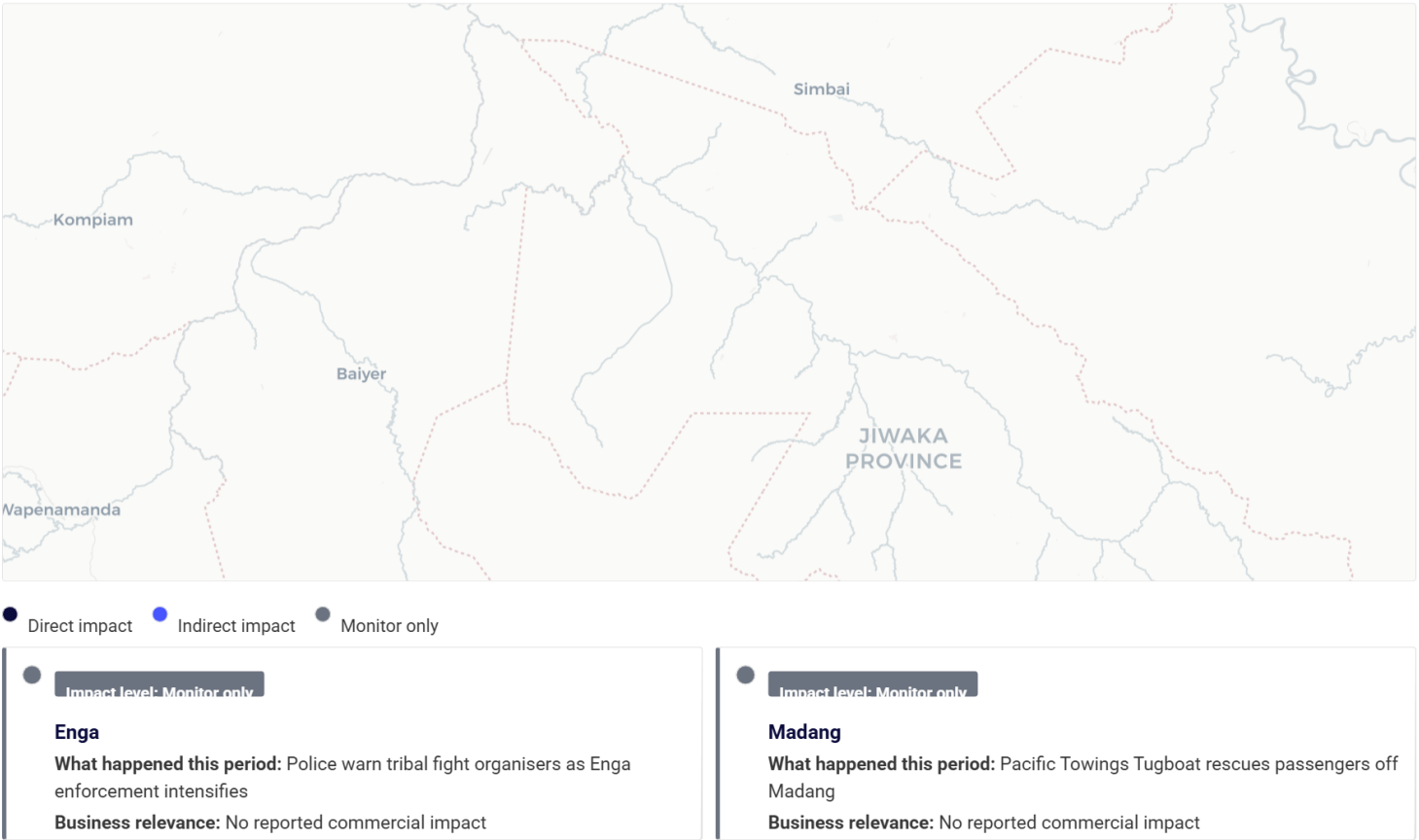
POLESTAR VIEW

On assessment, the risk is localised and varies by location, and it is best managed through location-specific decisions rather than country-

wide measures. The key judgement is that maritime drives the current concern, while other categories contributed limited, separate disruption. Businesses should prioritise verified route and site information for Madang and Papua New Guinea over broad precautionary measures.

Operational Map

Reported operational issues this period



Points show reported events at the town or province named in the reporting; where several share a location one marker carries the count. A marker is a town or province-level fix, not an exact point.

Map Read

This map shows reported operationally relevant issues for the current reporting period. Not every security or crime incident creates commercial impact. Direct impact is used only where reporting shows a current or confirmed effect on operations, movement, access, site security, utilities, production, logistics, workforce safety or business continuity. Indirect impact marks issues relevant to the operating environment with no confirmed effect on a client site, route, workforce, movement, production, access, utilities or logistics. Background incidents, preparedness meetings, isolated crime, political or legal developments, corruption investigations and general policing are Monitor only unless a clear operational effect is reported.

DISCLAIMER

Polestar Advisory Pte. Ltd. is an independent company registered in Singapore. The information in this report is based on open sources and is assessed as accurate at the time of writing. It is provided for general informational purposes only and does not constitute advice or a comprehensive assessment of all risks. No reliance should be placed on this information for operational decision-making without further independent verification.